# Lonjezo Sithole

Department of Economics, University of Michigan

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## Education

**University of Michigan** — Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. Economics — 2021–present
M.A. Economics (en route to Ph.D.) — 2023

**University of Edinburgh** — Edinburgh, UK
MSc Econometrics, with Distinction — 2018–2019

**University of Malawi** — Zomba, Malawi
M.A. Economics, with Distinction — 2016–2018
BSoc.Sci Economics, Upper Second Class — 2008–2012

## Fields

Primary: Econometrics
Secondary: Machine Learning, Labor Economics

## Working Papers

*Multi-Margin Selection in Leniency Designs* **Job Market Paper**

*Anatomy of the First Stage with Ordered Treatments*

*A Locally Robust Semiparametric Approach to Examiner IV Designs*
Reject & Resubmit, *Journal of Econometrics*. Awarded the 2024 Outstanding Third Year Paper Prize.

*Nonparametric Testability of Slutsky Symmetry* (with Florian Gunsilius)
Submitted.

## Work in Progress

*Semisupervised Causal Inference with Unstructured Data*

*Maximum Overlap Component Analysis* (with Florian Gunsilius)

## Presentations

### *Conference Presentations*

*Multi-Margin Selection in Leniency Designs*

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|---|---|
| 2026 | Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada (Plenary) |
| 2026 | Econometric Society Australasia Meeting, Adelaide, Australia (Oral) |
| 2026 | Bristol Econometrics Study Group, Bristol, United Kingdom (Oral) |
| 2026 | Celebrating James G. MacKinnon's 75th Birthday Conference, Aarhus Center of Econometrics, Denmark (Oral, Main Program) |

*Last updated: October 2026*

*Nonparametric Testability of Slutsky Symmetry*

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| 2025 | World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul, South Korea (Oral) |
| 2025 | International Association for Applied Econometrics Annual Conference, Turin, Italy (Oral) |
| 2025 | Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting, Ottawa, Canada (Poster) |

***Seminars***

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|---|---|
| Fall 2026 | Econometrics Seminar, University of Michigan |
| Winter 2026 | Econometrics Student Workshop, University of Michigan |
| Fall 2025 | Labor Lunch Seminar, University of Michigan |
| Summer 2025 | Summer Econometrics Workshop, University of Michigan (2x) |
| Winter 2025 | Econometrics Student Workshop, University of Michigan |
| Fall 2024 | Labor Lunch Seminar, University of Michigan |

## Professional Service

Referee: *Journal of Econometrics*

Discussant: *Discrete Choice with Endogenous Peer Selection* (Kashaev & Lazzati, 2025), 2025 Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting

## Teaching

*Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan*

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|---|---|
| Econ 672 (First-Year Ph.D.): Econometric Analysis II | Winter 2026 |
| Econ 675 (Second-Year Ph.D.): Applied Microeconometrics<br>*Also guest lecturer in both terms.* | Fall 2024, Fall 2025 |
| Econ 504 (Master of Applied Economics): Econometrics for Applied Economics | Winter 2024 |
| Econ 503 (Master of Applied Economics): Introduction to Probability & Statistics | Fall 2023 |
| Econ 251 (Undergraduate): Introduction to Econometrics | Fall 2022, Winter 2023 |

## Honors & Awards

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| 2024 | Outstanding Third Year Paper Award, University of Michigan |
| 2019 | Prize for the Best Econometrics Project, University of Edinburgh |
| 2016 | Global Young Leader, Johnson & Johnson |
| 2012 | Leader of Our Time, University of Malawi Graduating Class |
| 2009–2010 | Dean's Commendation for Best Performance, Faculty of Social Science, University of Malawi |
| | Defender of Academic Freedom, University of Malawi Academic Staff Union |

## Scholarships, Grants & Fellowships

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|---|---|
| 2026–2027 | Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship, University of Michigan |
| 2026 | Economics Department Travel Award, University of Michigan (May) |

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| 2025 | Rackham Conference Travel Grant, University of Michigan (May and June) |
| 2025 | Economics Department Travel Award, University of Michigan (April) |
| 2025 | Lawrence Klein Fellowship in Econometrics, University of Michigan (Winter) |
| 2021–2022 | Summer Research Apprenticeships, University of Michigan |
| 2021 | William Haber Fellowship, University of Michigan |
| 2018–2019 | Beit–Edinburgh Scholarship, University of Edinburgh |
| 2018 | Bristol Graduate Excellence Scholarship (Declined) |
| 2018 | Chevening Scholarship (Declined) |
| 2017 | Chevening Scholarship (Declined) |

## Service & Extracurriculars

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| 2024–Present | Advisor, Graduate International Applications Network (GAIN), University of Zurich |
| 2022–Present | Advisor, Global Health Corps, New York |
| 2023 | Co-Founder, Black Economics Graduate Students Society, University of Michigan |
| 2023 | Department Steward, Graduate Employees Organization, University of Michigan |
| 2022–2024 | Coordinator, Graduate International Applications Network—Alumni Chapter |
| 2022 | DEI Representative, Graduate Economics Society (GES), University of Michigan |
| 2018–2019 | Program Representative, University of Edinburgh |
| 2010–2012 | President, University of Malawi Students Union |

## Previous Employment

**World Bank**, Washington, DC 2019–2021
Short-Term Consultant

**Malawi National AIDS Commission**, Lilongwe, Malawi 2014–2018
Monitoring & Evaluation Officer

**Lighthouse Trust**, Lilongwe, Malawi 2013–2014
Monitoring & Evaluation Fellow, Global Health Corps Fellowship (New York)

## Professional Memberships

Econometric Society; Institute of Mathematical Statistics; European Economic Association; Economic Association of Malawi

## Additional Information

**Citizenship:** Malawian
**Software:** Advanced: R, Python, Git. Intermediate: Stata, Matlab.
**Languages:** English (Fluent); French (A2–Beginner); Spanish (Beginner)

## Dissertation Committee

**Kaspar Wuthrich** (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
kasparwu@umich.edu

**Florian Gunsilius** (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics
Emory University
fgunsil@emory.edu

**Eva Janssens**
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**Andreas Hagemann**
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